AKIF KARABAY

English Language Instructor | Language Testing & Assessment Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

CELTA-qualified English language instructor and assessment specialist with 14 years of experience across university preparatory programmes, secondary schools and adult language education. Served four years on a university Testing & Evaluation Committee, designing and analysing CEFR-aligned proficiency, placement and achievement exams and developing speaking and writing rubrics. Completed MA ELT coursework in curriculum development, language testing and second language acquisition. Experienced in leading English departments, mentoring teaching staff and running examiner standardisation sessions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Language Testing & Assessment:** design, vetting and statistical analysis of proficiency, placement, mid-term and achievement exams aligned with CEFR.
- **Rubrics & Standardisation:** analytic and criteria-referenced rubrics for Speaking and Writing; norming and calibration sessions to ensure inter-rater reliability.
- **Curriculum & Syllabus Design:** course structures from A1 to exam-preparation levels, including intensive programmes for Turkish national university entrance and language exams (YKS-DİL, YDS).
- **Academic Leadership:** Head of Department and Institute Director; teacher mentoring, lesson-delivery standards and formative evaluation.
- **Technology:** Moodle, Audacity, OptiJet, Dijider, Microsoft Office; interactive online learning tools and video content for learners.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

İdeal Eğitim Kurumları | Kayseri, Turkey — *Aug 2020 – Present*

Head of English Department / Coordinator

- Lead the English department and design exam-preparation curricula, including intensive YKS-DİL and YDS programmes and marathon revision camps.
- Run large-scale diagnostic “Trial Clubs” (practice exam series), tracking results to set personalised student targets.
- Supervise and mentor teaching staff, standardising lesson delivery and formative evaluation practices.

Trend English | Kayseri, Turkey — *Jan 2019 – Aug 2020*

Director

- Managed the institute’s academic strategy and led curriculum modernisation projects for adult learners.
- Designed tailored English modules for working professionals, aligned with international standards.

Kavram Koleji | Kayseri, Turkey — *Jan 2017 – Jan 2018*

Head of English Department

- Led the implementation of student-centred English programmes at secondary level.
- Standardised testing criteria across grade levels and introduced continuous assessment of productive skills.

American Life Language Institute | Kayseri, Turkey — *Nov 2016 – Jan 2017*

English Language Instructor

- Taught communicative English to adult learners across multiple CEFR levels.

Melikşah University, School of Foreign Languages | Kayseri, Turkey — *Aug 2012 – Jul 2016*

English Language Instructor & Testing and Evaluation Committee Member

- Served four years on the Testing & Evaluation Committee, improving the reliability of institution-wide exams.
- Designed, vetted and analysed high-stakes proficiency, placement and mid-term assessments for the preparatory programme.
- Created criteria-referenced rubrics for Speaking and Writing to reduce grading bias.
- Organised and led norming and calibration workshops to standardise scoring among faculty.

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITY

Aktif İngilizce | Online English education brand *Oct 2025 – Present*
Founder & Content Creator

- Produce English-learning content for YouTube, TikTok and Instagram (@aktif.ingilizce).
- Design interactive online practice tools for learners, including reading comprehension activities and TOEFL-style practice exams.

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

Çağ University | Mersin, Turkey *Completed 2020*
MA in English Language Teaching (coursework completed)

- Postgraduate study in Curriculum Development, Language Testing and Assessment, and Second Language Acquisition.

CELTA | Cambridge English Language Assessment, Istanbul, Turkey *2014*
Certificate in English Language Teaching to Adults

Erciyes University | Kayseri, Turkey *2008 – 2012*
BA in English Language and Literature

- Completed the Certificate in English Language Teaching (Pedagogical Formation) alongside the degree.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Testing, Evaluation and Assessment Masterclass | Erciyes University & SELT Academy, Kayseri, Turkey *2014 – 2016*

HONOURS

- Certificate of Appreciation for outstanding contribution to the Testing & Evaluation Committee, School of Foreign Languages (June 2015).

LANGUAGES

Turkish: Native **English:** Advanced / professional proficiency

REFERENCES

Available upon request.